

Private Sector Pathways (PSP) Program

Supporting the Health and Wellbeing of Queenslanders

Challenge Statement

This Private Sector Pathways (PSP) Challenge seeks innovative Queensland-based organisations with practical and scalable solutions to support the health and wellbeing of Queenslanders and help reduce pressure on the public health system.

This may include solutions that:

- Improve access to timely and personalised health and wellbeing programs and services that help Queenslanders prevent, delay and manage chronic disease by supporting them to build and sustain healthier habits, alongside usual clinical care;
- help Queenslanders stay healthy and well in the community for longer by addressing modifiable risk factors (e.g. nutrition, physical activity, sleep, social and emotional wellbeing) for the prevention and early intervention of chronic diseases such as obesity, diabetes, and heart disease.

Ideal solutions will make it easier for consumers to find relevant, targeted and evidence-based programs and services, that are free or low-cost. This can include local, state or national programs and services that target one or many modifiable risk factors for chronic disease.

Challenge Owner

This challenge is co-led by Queensland Health and Health and Wellbeing Queensland, in partnership with the Department of Environment, Tourism, Science and Innovation (DETSI), Innovation Division.

Queensland Health is one of Australia's largest public healthcare systems, caring for more than 5.6 million people across Queensland through a network of 230 facilities, including 106 public hospitals. Our services include hospitals, pathology, community health, mental health, preventive health, aged care, ambulance services and virtual care, supporting Queenslanders across all stages of life. Queensland Health includes the Department of Health, the Queensland Ambulance Service and 16 Hospital and Health Services (HHSs), supported by more than 130,000 dedicated staff, including doctors, nurses, allied health professionals and support workers. Together, we manage more than 2.3 million emergency department visits each year, as well as millions of hospital stays, outpatient appointments, surgeries, and diagnostic tests. From emergency treatment to preventive health programs, Queensland Health is committed to providing world class health services when Queenslanders need them.

Health and Wellbeing Queensland is the state's prevention agency. We deliver high impact prevention through partnerships across government, communities and sectors. Prevention efforts aim to build supportive, sustainable, healthier environments; empower people to stay healthier; and enable access to prevention, early intervention and supportive healthcare. Health and Wellbeing Queensland is addressing the drivers of preventable chronic disease to ease pressure off the health system and create a lasting legacy of healthier communities.

Challenge Context

The Current Situation

Chronic disease is a growing challenge in Queensland, driving increased hospital admissions, rising healthcare costs, and greater system strain. Many individuals are experiencing multiple chronic conditions, despite evidence that up to 40% of the disease burden in Australia is preventable.

Addressing this requires a shift from reactive, “break-fix” care to a proactive, “predict-prevent” approach. This includes stronger collaboration across and beyond the health system to better support prevention, early intervention, and ongoing management.

Currently, many Queenslanders at risk of chronic disease are not connected to proactive care. While a range of free, low-cost, evidence-based health and wellbeing programs exist, they are often fragmented, poorly integrated, and difficult to navigate. As a result, participation remains low, meaning many individuals lack the support needed to improve health behaviours and reduce risk factors.

Barriers such as system complexity, limited visibility, and insufficient consideration of individual needs and circumstances, such as health and digital literacy, cultural context, and accessibility, further limit access and engagement.

Challenge Imperative

Improving the visibility, coordination, and accessibility of preventative health programs presents a significant opportunity to improve population health outcomes and reduce pressure on the health system. By enabling people to better understand their options and access timely, appropriate support across phone, group-based, and digital formats, Queenslanders can be more effectively supported to prevent and manage chronic disease.

Proposed solutions should empower individuals to access and engage with programs and services aligned to their needs and circumstances. This includes approaches that strengthen prevention, early intervention, navigation, engagement, coordination, and the use of technology to improve the experience of care. Solutions must balance personalisation with scalability, delivering tailored support without adding unnecessary complexity or administrative burden.

Queensland Health and Health and Wellbeing Queensland are seeking practical, implementable solutions that demonstrate measurable improvements in people’s confidence and ability to access and engage with appropriate supports. While solutions are not expected to address all aspects of the challenge within the pilot phase, they should deliver clear impact for a defined population group, use case, or area of health and wellbeing (e.g. people with specific modifiable risk factors such as low physical activity and poor dietary intake, specific age cohorts (e.g. Queenslanders aged 18-45 years), or communities in defined geographic locations (e.g. regional, rural or remote areas).

Case Study – Wellness my Way

Wellness my Way (<https://hw.qld.gov.au/wellnessmyway/>) is a community-based program that connects individuals with health and wellbeing programs, services and resources aligned to their personal goals. Following a digital health check, individuals can access support from a telephone coach for tailored, goal-based action planning and referral to free/low cost, evidence-based prevention programs delivered locally or statewide. The program supports individuals' awareness of, and navigation to, existing prevention programs and services, helping them take proactive steps to improve their health. **However, mapping and maintaining referral pathways and actioning referrals is a manual process managed by the program team and telephone coaches, respectively. Ongoing delivery and scalability of Wellness my Way could be enhanced through the PSP Challenge, by providing digital tools that streamline access to relevant programs, including location-specific delivery.**

The Intended Objectives/Outcomes

The objective of this challenge is to improve the prevention and early management of chronic disease by delivering a user-friendly, integrated system that enables Queenslanders to easily discover, access, and engage with personalised preventive health programs and services tailored to their needs and location.

The intended outcome is a more visible, coordinated, and accessible preventive health system that enables Queenslanders to confidently navigate available supports and receive timely, appropriate care aligned to their needs. This will contribute to improved health outcomes and reduced preventable disease burden, easing pressure on the healthcare system.

Success will be demonstrated through measurable improvements in user engagement, confidence in navigating preventive programs and services, and increased uptake of appropriate supports within defined populations or use cases.

Solutions should consider principles identified below.

Principles	Short Summary
Cost Effectiveness and Scalability	Solutions should be cost effective and feasible to implement within a pilot setting, without significantly increasing long-term operational costs. While full scalability is not required during the pilot phase, solutions should demonstrate potential for broader applicability across Queensland where appropriate.
Accessibility and Usability	Solutions must be intuitive and easy to use for health consumers and carers. Solutions should be accessible and suitable for users with varying levels of digital literacy, health literacy and accessibility needs.
Personalisation and Relevance	Solutions should be responsive to individual needs, circumstances and preferences. This may include delivering clear and context-aware guidance, supports or interactions that improve understanding, navigation and engagement with appropriate programs and services.
Alignment	Solutions should demonstrate awareness of existing healthcare and community-based services, supports initiatives in Queensland and complement rather than duplicate, without adding complexity or administrative burden.

Consumer Navigation and Decision Support	Solutions should empower community to make informed decisions and connect with appropriate programs and services by providing clearer pathways, ensuring access to accurate information, and providing timely supports.
Privacy and Digital Health Requirements	Solutions should ensure secure handling of information in line with privacy, security and digital health requirements.
Collaborative Design	During the pilot period the solution should incorporate user feedback from health consumers, carers and relevant stakeholders to ensure real-world needs, workflows and user preferences are reflected.
Equity and cultural safety	Solutions should be accessible, inclusive and proportionate, considering the needs of all Queenslanders, especially those facing the greatest challenges.
Evidence-informed and evidence generating	Solutions should promote evidence-based programs, guided by ongoing monitoring and evaluation to strengthen decision making and drive improvement.

The Stakeholders Involved

Supporting the health and wellbeing of Queenslanders requires collaboration across diverse stakeholders to ensure solutions are practical, inclusive and responsive.

- **Community and Health consumers** are central to shaping accessible and relevant solutions through their lived experiences.
- **Carers and families** support consumers to understand and access relevant preventive health programs and services, and play an important role in engagement and ongoing participation.
- **Healthcare providers** (clinicians, allied health professionals and supporting staff) benefit from improved consumer understanding, better engagement with preventive care, and more visible and coordinated referral pathways.
- **Service navigators, liaison officers and support staff** ensure solutions promote health literacy, equity, and inclusion across the healthcare journey and regions.
- **Health communication organisations and community representatives** help ensure solutions support health literacy, accessibility, equity and inclusion across metropolitan, regional, rural and remote Queensland communities.

Challenge Solution

Outcomes Desired

The desired outcome is the delivery of an innovative and practical solution that supports the health and wellbeing of Queenslanders by improving access to, navigation of, and engagement with preventive health programs and services, enabling:

- improved confidence and experience for health consumers, carers and those managing care for others,

- better understanding of, and engagement with, appropriate preventive health programs and services,
- more informed decision-making and improved health outcomes.

Solution Outcomes	Considerations
Technical and/or Regulatory Considerations	The solution must: • Be capable of operating as a standalone pilot solution without requiring integration or interoperability with Queensland Health or Health and Wellbeing Queensland clinical or enterprise systems. • Minimise implementation complexity, technical dependencies and ongoing support requirements. • Ensure secure handling of information in line with privacy, security and digital health requirements. • Be adaptable to future needs and evolving requirements. The solution should: • Be simple, practical and low burden to implement, maintain and support. • Avoid creating additional technical complexity, integration dependencies or ongoing administrative burden. • Leverage existing publicly available or organisation-provided information where appropriate.
Sustainability and Implementation	The solution must: • Minimise additional workload for staff during implementation and demonstrate how the solution may reduce administrative burden over time. • Be adaptable to future needs and evolving requirements, recognising the pilot nature and scope of this challenge. The solution should: • Demonstrate potential for broader adoption over time. • Leverage existing resources where possible.
Design Benefits	The solution must: • Be user-friendly and accessible for individuals with varying levels of digital literacy, health literacy and accessibility needs. • Support clear, accessible and responsive interactions, pathways or supports tailored to user needs. • Be informed by user testing or feedback loops with health consumers, carers and relevant stakeholders. • Be accessible and usable across a range of settings, delivery approaches or platforms where appropriate. The solution should: • Support continuous improvement through user feedback, evaluation and operational insights. • Improve understanding of available services, supports and next steps where appropriate.

How to apply

Applications can be submitted via the link [here](#) and should include the following:

- A clear description of the solution, including its key features, benefits, assumptions and value proposition.
- A roadmap for implementation, including timelines, resources and milestones.
- A plan for measuring the impact and success of the solution, including metrics and evaluation criteria.
- A budget that outlines the financial requirements for implementing and maintaining the solution.
- A summary of the team's qualifications and experience, including relevant skills and expertise.

Closed Pitch Event for Shortlisted Applicants

Shortlisted applicants will be invited to pitch their solution to Queensland Health, Health and Wellbeing Queensland and the Department of Environment, Tourism, Science and Innovation (DETSI) at a closed pitch event in August 2026. Key stakeholders may be invited to be in the audience, including representatives from other government departments and agencies that could be interested in applying the proposed solutions.

Support will be provided to finalists with pitch training and/or coaching.

Successful Applicant(s)

The winning proposal(s) will be selected based on its innovation, feasibility, impact and alignment with the challenge objectives, and announced at the 2026 Health and Wellbeing Queensland Symposium on 1-2 September 2026. The successful applicant/s will be invited to deliver a short pitch of their solution at the Symposium. The successful applicant/s will receive grant funding of up to \$200,000 (excluding GST) through Queensland Health, Health and Wellbeing Queensland and the DETSI Innovation Division to pilot their proposed solution for 6-8 months with Health and Wellbeing Queensland.

Project Duration

The duration of the project, following successful outcome at the open pitch event, is estimated to be 6-8 months. Project commencement is expected to begin around October 2026, subject to contracting.

More information

The DETSI Innovation [Private Sector Pathways \(PSP\)](#) program aims to solve corporate challenges with solutions generated by proven innovative Queensland small to medium enterprises and scaleups. For more information about the PSP Challenge, contact DETSI Innovation Private Sector Partnerships team at partnerships2@detsi.qld.gov.au.

Further information about DETSI strategies can be found at:

- [DETSI Strategic Plan 2023-27](#)

Join us in this endeavour to support the health and wellbeing of Queenslanders and help people access the right care, at the right time, in the right place.

Further information can be found at:

- [doh-strategic-plan-2025-2029.pdf](#)
- [Health and Wellbeing Queensland Strategic Plan 2023-2027](#)